MY SITUATION ROOM

Command Centre Operator Manual

Election observation & real-time collation

An AI Brains Ventures production

This guide is for **you, the client**: the organisation running a Command Centre to observe an election. It covers everything, step by step — setting up your rooms, your observers, watching the field live, collating results, resolving disputes, and exporting your evidence.

> **Your operation is private.** No other Command Centre can see your rooms, observers, map, video, audio, photos, messages or audit trail — isolation is enforced in the database itself. The one thing that may be combined is **vote counts**: where the platform administrator has enabled it, Global Collation adds up the figures of all Command Centres in the same state (section 6).

The structure you'll build

```
Your Command Centre  (you)
   └── Situation Rooms   (one per LGA / area — each has a supervisor)
         └── Observers  (field agents, two per polling unit)
```

- **You** create Situation Rooms and extra operators.
- **A Situation Room supervisor** logs into their room and creates **observer codes** for their area.
- **Observers** install the app, lock it to their phone, and report from their polling unit.

---

1. Signing in

1. Open the login link from your invite — `https://mysituationroom.com.ng/command/`.
2. Choose **Command Centre**, enter your **operator name** and **passcode** (from the invite).
   - **Or scan the QR code** on your invite: with your phone camera, or with **Scan QR code instead** on the sign-in screen. It fills in the details and signs you in.
3. First thing: go to **App Settings → change your passcode** to something only you know.

Turn on two-step login (do this)

In **App Settings**, enable **two-step login** and scan the QR code with Google Authenticator or Authy. From then on each login also needs the 6-digit code. This protects your command even if your passcode leaks.

Add more operators (optional)

In **App Settings** you can add colleagues as operators of *your* Command Centre — each gets their own name and passcode, and can enable their own two-step login. You can disable or reset any of them. If someone loses their authenticator phone, clear their two-step login so they can re-enrol.

---

2. Create your Situation Rooms

A Situation Room is one area of responsibility — usually one LGA. **Situation Rooms** tab:

One room at a time — choose the election

Situation Rooms tab → **Create Situation Room**. The first drop-down is **the election the room is for**, grouped by **type of election**:

Type of election	Choose	Covers	You pick
LGA	**LGA Chairman**	exactly one LGA	one LGA (round buttons)
State	**Governor**	the whole state	nothing — no LGAs to choose
Federal	**Presidential**	the whole state	nothing — no LGAs to choose
Federal	**Senator** (senatorial district)	several LGAs	tick each LGA in the district
Federal	**House of Reps** (federal constituency)	several LGAs	tick each LGA in the constituency
Other	**Custom zone**	any LGAs	tick the ones you want

The form shows **Type of election: LGA / State / Federal** under the drop-down. Choose the state (it is fixed if your Command Centre belongs to one state), then — for LGA, Senator, Reps and zones — pick the LGAs. If a state's LGA list has not been loaded, type the LGA names separated by commas. Name the room (or leave it blank for an automatic name such as "Governorship — Kano"), add the operator, and press **Create Room**.

A room can issue observer codes **only in its LGAs** (a Governor or Presidential room: anywhere in its state).

Elections are kept apart. The same polling unit votes in several elections, so each room's observers report **that election only**. Figures from different elections are never reconciled against each other and never added together by accident: on **Global Collation** and **Results Review** pick the **CONTEST** (LGA Chairman, Governorship, Presidential, Senate, House of Reps) to see one election at a time — if you leave it on *All* and more than one election exists, the screen warns you that the totals mix elections. A room's own *Whole LGA / Whole zone / Whole state* view adds up only rooms of **its own election**.

All LGAs at once (fast setup)

Use **One room per LGA** to create a room for every LGA in your state in one click, then download the CSV of room IDs + passcodes, and a second file — a **QR sheet** (`…-QR.html`) with one sign-in card per room. Open that file to view, print or save as PDF. This is the quickest way to stand up a whole state.

Managing a room (buttons on each row)

- **Rename** — change its display name.
- **New passcode** — reset that room's passcode (the old one stops working); the new one shows once.
- **Suspend** — temporarily stop the room (its observers can't report); **Activate** to resume.

- **Deactivate** — take the room offline at the end of the day.
- **Drill** — open a **read-only** view *inside* that room (its map, observers, collation, radio) so you can watch a single area without leaving the Command Centre.

Reset & download ALL passcodes

In the Situation Rooms header, **Reset & download all passcodes** generates a fresh passcode for every room and downloads **two files**: a CSV (`room_id, room_name, lga, passcode, login_url, qr_sign_in_link`) and a **QR sheet** (`Situation-Room-sign-in-sheets-QR.html`) with one QR card per room. The QR codes are in the second file — open it in your browser and print it. (It resets them, so use it once when you're ready to distribute.)

---

3. How a Situation Room supervisor works (share this part with them)

Your supervisors use the **Situation Room app** (download from the landing page) or the browser.

1. Open `https://mysituationroom.com.ng/room/` (or the Situation Room Android app, entering the site address once).
2. Sign in with the **Room ID** and **passcode** you gave them — or just **scan the QR code** on their card (phone camera, or the **Scan QR code** button).

   > **In the Android app the very first screen asks for the web address, not the passcode.** Tap **Scan QR code** and scan the card (it sets the address and signs in), or leave the address as `mysituationroom.com.ng` and tap **Connect**; the Room ID and passcode are typed on the *next* screen.

3. They then:
   - **Create observer codes** for their area (section 4),
   - watch their observers on the **map**, request **live video**,
   - see their **collation** and **results**, and the **radio** monitor,
   - resolve **disputes** for their polling units.

A supervisor only ever sees their own room.

---

4. Add observers (done inside a Situation Room)

Observer codes are created **in the room**, by its supervisor, so each code is tied to the right area. Do a whole batch at once:

1. In the Situation Room open **Observer Manager** → **Generate observer codes**.
2. **Tick the LGAs** the batch is for (a room covering Rogo and Karaye shows both; tick one, both, or use *all*). Everything under a ticked LGA starts ticked — its **wards** and **polling units** — so you only **untick** what you do not want. *all / none* links speed this up for LGAs, wards and polling units.
3. Choose **Observers per polling unit** (2 is recommended: two independent witnesses make a result trustworthy). The screen shows the total: for example *18 polling units → 36 new codes*.

Units that already have observers only get what is missing, so you can safely run it again.

4. Press **Generate**. A window offers **Print QR cards** (one card per observer to hand out) and **Download list** (a spreadsheet of the codes).
5. **Names are optional.** Type each observer's name in the **Name** box of the Observers list whenever you have it — it saves as you leave the box.

To add a single observer by typing the LGA, ward and polling unit, open **Add one observer by typing the details**. Registered voters for each unit come from the polling-unit list automatically.

The observer's first login (they do this)

1. Install the **Observer app** from `/download/app` (or open `/observer/`).
2. **Scan the QR card** (it connects the app and fills in the code), or enter the **site address** when asked (once) and type the **code**. Then they choose a **PIN**.
3. The code **locks to that phone**. If they switch phones, the code won't work until you reset it.

Who a Situation Room is for

When you create a room, choose its type: **LGA Chairman** (exactly one LGA), **Senator** (a senatorial district), **House of Reps** (a federal constituency) or a **custom zone** — for the last three, tick only the LGAs that zone covers. The room can issue observer codes and see results **only** in those LGAs, and its **Whole zone** collation view adds up every room covering them.

What the observer does on election day (tell them this)

- **Tallies add up.** Each figure they say ("APC 251") or type is **added to that party's running total** — so they can enter results in parts. To fix a mistake they tap the party's row and set the correct total; entry never locks, so they can keep adding figures all day.
- **Voice typing: say, confirm, send.** With the mic on, the observer says a party and its figures — "APC 20", "PDP 20", "APC 30", "APC 50". The party named is brought forward, and figures for it add up (20 + 30 + 50 = 100). The app shows the staged totals and reads them back: *"Confirm APC total 100 votes"*. **Nothing is sent to the Situation Room until the observer says "confirm"** (or taps **Confirm & send**). They can type a corrected total in the box first, say "undo" to drop the last figure, or "cancel" to clear. The speaker button switches the read-back off. Typed entries (the party list and + button) are added straight away.
- **Messages** from the room appear on their screen. They are **not read aloud**.
- **Talk-back:** while they are streaming, they hear the room (or a shared viewer) speaking to them through the phone, and the room hears them.
- **Stealth mode** turns the screen into a plain clock. Three quick taps on the clock send a silent SOS. To leave stealth: **press and hold the clock for two seconds**, or tap the faint word "open" at the bottom-right.

Managing an observer (from the room or the Command Centre)

- **Reset device** — unlocks the code so it can be enrolled on a new phone (lost/replaced phone).
- **Revoke / disable** — instantly ends that observer's access.
- **Request live** — ask the observer's phone to start streaming (section 5).

5. Watch the field live (video, GPS, talk-back)

Observers & Map tab (Command Centre), or the map inside a room.

- The map shows every observer as a dot with their **GPS** position and a **live/streaming** tag.
- Click an observer → **Request live** to have their phone start the camera.
- **Multiple people can watch the same observer at once.** You and the Situation Room supervisor (and several of your operators) can all view the same feed simultaneously — the phone only uploads once.
- **Talk back** — push-to-talk audio to the observer while watching.
- **Restream** — paste an `rtmp://` / `rtmps://` URL (with its stream key) to push that observer's feed to an external service (a war-room screen, a partner, or a public live stream) for unlimited viewers. **Stop restream** ends it.

> Observers only stream **when asked** (to save their data and battery), and the screen stays awake while streaming. GPS keeps updating in the background.

5a. Share a live view with people outside the system

Use this for party leadership, a partner organisation, a media desk or a war-room screen — people who should **see** what is happening but must not be able to change anything.

Share Live View tab (Command Centre or Situation Room):

1. Give the view a **name**.
2. Choose **what it shows**: *all* your observers (new ones are added automatically), or **only the observers you tick**.
3. Set a **passcode** (or leave blank to auto-generate), how long it **stays open**, and whether viewers may **talk to observers** (talk-back).
4. Click **Create shared view**. You get the **link**, the **passcode** and a **QR** for the link — shown once. Send the link and passcode to your viewers, ideally by different channels.

What the viewer gets (after entering the passcode): **live collation**, the **map**, and **live video** of the shared observers, and they can **move between LGAs, wards, polling units and feeds** (Previous / Next, the list, or the map). Any number of people can watch at once. If you allowed it, they can talk to the observer. There are **no control buttons** — a viewer cannot create, edit, resolve, message or export anything, and the viewer pass opens nothing else in the system.

Watching a feed asks that observer's phone to start its camera; when the last viewer leaves, it is switched off again automatically. **Revoke** a view (same tab) to cut off everyone using it at once.

6. Global Collation (the running tally)

Global Collation tab. Figures arrive as observers report them, sorted by votes, highest first, and the parties re-order live as numbers come in. The six major parties (APN, APC, ADC, NDC, PDP, LP) are shown; drill **LGA → Ward → Polling Unit** to see any level. The search bar is locked to **your**

state and lists only its LGAs, wards, polling units and rooms. Use **PARTY** (or type a party name such as "APC" in the search box) to show one party only. In a live election the figures keep rising as observers submit.

Whole state, or this Command Centre only

Observers & Map always shows only **your own** observers. **Global Collation** can show more:

- **Whole state** (default) — the vote counts of **every Command Centre in your state**, added up by LGA, ward and polling unit. A blue note says how many polling units and votes come from **external observers** (other Command Centres' observers). Each polling unit is counted **once**: your own figure for a unit always stands; where you have none, the best-evidenced figure from another centre is used.
- **This Command Centre only** — just your own figures.

A **Situation Room** has the same switch on its collation: **Whole LGA** adds up every Situation Room covering that LGA — sister rooms in your Command Centre and rooms of the other Command Centres in the state — and **This room only** shows just its own observers' figures.

Only **vote counts** are combined. You never see another centre's map, video, audio, photos or observer details, and they never see yours.

---

7. Results Review — the trust engine

This is what lets you **defend your numbers**. **Results Review** tab. Every polling unit moves through a status as its two observers report:

Status	Meaning
pending	no figures yet
single	only one observer has reported
partial	both reported but some parties differ
matched	both observers' figures agree
disputed	the two observers disagree
resolved	a supervisor settled a disputed unit
verified	matched *or* resolved **and** an EC8A photo is on file

Resolve a dispute

1. Filter to **Disputed**.
2. Open the unit — you see **both observers' figures side by side**.
3. Check them against the **EC8A result-sheet photo** the observers uploaded.
4. Enter the correct figures and **Resolve**. (Use **Unresolve** to reopen if needed.)

What "verified" means

A unit is **verified** only when two independent witnesses agree (or a dispute was resolved) **and** there's a photo of the EC8A to prove it. Each photo carries a SHA-256 fingerprint recorded at upload as tamper evidence. Filter to **Verified** to show your rock-solid units.

---

8. Radio monitor

Radio tab. Plays back radio transmissions captured per area, labelled by room, with a per-room filter at the Command Centre.

The **Radio receiver** panel (a room's Radio tab, or the Command Center's Radio tab once you choose a room) controls that room's listening post:

- **ON / OFF** — switches the radio receiver on or off.
- **Frequency** — type it in MHz (e.g. `154.3500`) and press **Tune**, or nudge it with the **◀ 25k / ◀ 12.5k / 12.5k ▶ / 25k ▶** buttons. Choose **Narrow FM** (voice), **AM** or **Wide FM**.
- **Squelch** — higher ignores weaker signals; lower hears more noise.
- **☆ Save this channel** — keeps a named channel you can tune to in one tap.
- The status badge shows **Receiving 154.3500 MHz**, **Retuning…**, **Online · radio off** or **Listening post offline**. Changes reach the post within about 5 seconds.
- **Listen live: ON** plays each new transmission automatically as it arrives (tap it once so the browser allows sound).

The receiver only works once a listening post is running `tuner.js` (see `radio-gateway/README.md`).

> Radio comes from a **listening post** (an SDR receiver + antenna) placed near each area — **not** from observers' phones, which cannot receive VHF/UHF. To set one up for an area: in the Situation Room app → **Radio → Gateway key**, then follow `radio-gateway/README.md`. Until a listening post is connected, the monitor shows an empty state (never fake audio).

---

9. Broadcast messages

Broadcast tab. Send a message to all your Situation Rooms, to chosen rooms, to **everyone in an area**, or an emergency alert to **every observer**. Choose **By state / LGA / ward…**, then who should get it — **Situation Rooms that cover the area** or **every observer in the area** — then the state (fixed to yours), the LGA and, if you like, a ward. Leave LGA or ward on "All" to widen it. Recipients acknowledge receipt, and the list shows how many have.

---

10. Incidents

Observers can **report an incident** from the field (violence, irregularities, etc.). These surface in your Command Centre so you can act and keep a record. Each is time-stamped in the audit trail.

11. Contacts

Contacts tab. Keep a directory of your people (supervisors, observers, officials). Add them one by one or **bulk import**.

12. Export & Archive

Export & Archive tab — "your data, exportable any time."

- **Export** results and data as **CSV / JSON**.
- **Backups** — the server also keeps automatic database snapshots; you can download them here.

Export at the end of the day (or periodically) so you always hold your own copy of the evidence.

13. Audit Log

Audit Log tab — a time-stamped record of actions in *your* Command Centre (logins, room and observer changes, resolutions). Your accountability trail.

13b. Dark / light mode

The round button at the bottom-right of every dashboard switches between light and dark mode. Your choice is remembered on that device.

13a. Help

Help tab — this manual, inside the app, with a **Download PDF** button.

14. Good security habits (please follow)

- Change your passcode on day one; turn on **two-step login**.
- Give each Situation Room its **own** passcode; use **Reset & download all passcodes** to distribute cleanly, and **New passcode** if one leaks.
- Observers' codes are **device-locked** — only **Reset device** when a phone genuinely changed.
- **Revoke** any observer or operator who leaves immediately.
- **Export/backup** your data regularly.
- Only share login links and passcodes through private channels (never post them publicly).

15. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
A supervisor can't log in	Check the room is **Activated** (new rooms start inactive) and not **Suspended**; re-issue with **New passcode**.
The app says **"Failed to fetch"** / "Could not reach that address" on its first screen	That screen wants the **web address** (`mysituationroom.com.ng`), not the passcode. Tap **Scan QR code**, or enter the address and type the passcode on the next screen.
An observer's code won't work on a new phone	**Reset device** on that observer.
Map says "API KEY REQUIRED"	You're on an old build — have your admin redeploy; maps are keyless now.
No live video	Confirm the observer tapped to go live and has signal; ensure LiveKit is running on the server.
Radio monitor empty	A listening post hasn't been connected for that area yet (section 8).
Can't see another command's data	That's by design — each Command Centre is fully isolated.

Questions your platform provider can answer: deployment, the server, the radio listening posts, and anything about the Android apps.